

Subacromial Shoulder Program

Sequoia Rehabilitation Partners, 2840 Freeport Blvd, Sacramento, CA 95818. Prepared by A. Fry, PT, DPT. Patient handout, de-identified. Reviewed February 2026.

What this is

This is a home program for shoulder pain felt at the front and side of the upper arm, often worse with reaching overhead or behind the back. The goal is to load the rotator cuff so the tissue tolerates daily tasks again. Some discomfort during the work is fine. It should settle within a few hours.

Phase one, calm and control, weeks one to two

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Load	Cue
Scapular retraction	3	12	Red band	squeeze blades down and back
Isometric external rotation	3	20 sec hold	Light	elbow at the side
Pendulum swings	2	30 sec	None	let the arm hang and circle

Phase two, build, weeks three to six

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Load	Cue
Banded external rotation	3	15	Yellow band	slow return, no shrug
Prone Y raise	3	12	2 kg	thumb up, lift to ear height
Sleeper stretch	2	30 sec	None	gentle, never into pain

When to check in

Call the clinic if pain wakes you most nights, if the arm feels weak rather than sore, or if symptoms do not change in three weeks. Bring this sheet to your next visit and note which moves felt best.